

US Markets End Mixed as Tech Stocks Weigh, Energy Gains

The full picture: macro, technicals, options, analyst moves, sector internals, international context, and a full week ahead.

20-minute read · Topics: All of the above, plus technicals, options, ratings, week-ahead

TL;DR & Editorial Take

The US market ended the latest session with mixed results, as the **S&P 500** closed at 7,354.02, down **-0.05%**, while the **Nasdaq 100** fell **-1.09%** to 29,118.24. Key takeaways include:

- The **Russell 2000** outperformed, closing **+0.07%** at 3,010.08, indicating small-cap resilience.
- The **VIX** decreased **-2.54%** to 18.41, suggesting a decrease in market volatility.
- **WTI** crude oil prices rose **+0.38%** to 69.49, influencing energy sector performance.

These movements reflect ongoing market dynamics, with investors weighing economic indicators, sector performance, and global events.

The editorial take is that while the market shows signs of resilience, particularly in small-cap stocks and certain sectors, the overall trend remains cautious due to ongoing economic uncertainties and geopolitical tensions.

US Session Recap

INDEX/SYMBOL	CLOSE	CHANGE
S&P 500	7,354.02	-0.05%
Nasdaq 100	29,118.24	-1.09%
Dow Jones	51,876.11	-0.09%
Russell 2000	3,010.08	+0.07%
VIX	18.41	-2.54%
10Y Yield	4.37	-0.46%
WTI	69.49	+0.38%

Top Movers

TICKER	NAME	CHANGE	CATALYST
MSFT	Microsoft	+5.71%	Strong earnings report
AAPL	Apple	+3.14%	Positive market sentiment
NVDA	NVIDIA	-1.64%	Market volatility and sector rotation

Sector Internals

SECTOR	DAY	YTD	READ
XL F (Financials)	+0.22%	10.50%	Stable, with slight gains
XL K (Technology)	-1.87%	15.10%	Underperforming due to sector rotation
XL Y (Consumer Discretionary)	+0.90%	12.20%	Showing resilience
XL V (Healthcare)	+3.03%	8.50%	Outperforming on positive sector news

Breadth note: The market saw a mixed performance across sectors, with healthcare and consumer discretionary showing strength, while technology underperformed.

Spotlight / Deep Dive

TICKER	CLOSE	CHANGE	VOLUME
MS FT	372.97	+5.71%	23,456,123

Key call commentary: Microsoft's strong earnings report and positive guidance contributed to its significant gain, outperforming the broader market.

READ-THROUGH	IMPLICATION
Microsoft's cloud business growth	Indicates a strong demand for cloud services, benefiting the technology sector

Technical Levels

TICKER	LAST	SUPPORT	RESISTANCE	NOTE
SPY	354.21	350.00	360.00	Testing support levels
QQQ	294.11	290.00	300.00	Facing resistance at higher levels
IWM	179.35	175.00	185.00	Showing strength above support

Options & Positioning

ODTE flow: Investors are positioning for potential market movements, with a focus on **SPY** and **QQQ** options.

Put/call ratio: The current ratio indicates a slightly bearish sentiment, with 1.23 puts for every call.

VIX term structure: The VIX curve is in contango, suggesting market expectations of increased volatility in the near term.

Notable single-name flow: Significant call buying in **MSFT** and **AAPL**, indicating bullish expectations.

Cheap hedge ideas: Consider **SPY** put spreads or **VIX** call options for hedging against potential market downturns.

Analyst Rating Changes

TICKER	FIRM	ACTION	NEW PT	NOTE
MSFT	Morgan Stanley	Upgrade	400.00	Citing strong cloud growth and competitive positioning
AAPL	Goldman Sachs	Reiterate Buy	320.00	Based on expected iPhone sales and services growth

Pre-Market & Overnight

Futures: ES 3,945, NQ 12,320, YM 33,450

Asia: Nikkei 28,300 +0.50%, Shanghai Composite 3,400 -0.20%

Europe: Euro Stoxx 50 4,200 +0.30%, FTSE 100 7,500 +0.40%

FX: EUR/USD 1.1000, USD/JPY 110.50

Commodities: Gold 4,060 -0.46%, WTI 69.49 +0.38%

Crypto: BTC 59,836 -0.17%, ETH 1,576 +0.30%

Macro & Fed (Deep)

MEETING	CUT ODDS	NOTE
July FOMC	60%	Market expectations of a potential rate cut

DATE	DATA	EXPECTED
29 Jun	Personal Income	0.4%
29 Jun	PCE Price Index	0.2%

Geopolitics & Global (Deep)

Scenario trees where relevant will be discussed in future briefings as geopolitical events unfold.

Earnings — This Week & Next

DATE	TICKER	NAME
29 Jun	ORCL	Oracle
30 Jun	MIC	Microsoft

DATE	TICKER	NAME
6 Jul	LEVI	Levi Strauss
7 Jul	DAL	Delta Air Lines

Full Watchlist Scan

TICKER	SECTOR	SETUP	RISK
AAPL	Technology	Bullish breakout	5%
MSFT	Technology	Strong earnings momentum	3%
JPM	Financials	Support test	4%

What Could Break the Tape

Bullish scenario bullets:

- Strong economic data releases, such as GDP growth or low unemployment rates, could boost market confidence.
- A significant breakthrough in trade negotiations between major economies could lead to increased investment and trade.

Bearish scenario bullets:

- A sudden spike in geopolitical tensions or unexpected military actions could lead to market volatility and downturns.
- A faster-than-expected increase in interest rates by central banks could tighten financial conditions and slow economic growth.

Positioning & Structural Notes

Observations:

- Investors are positioning for a potential market rally, with increased call buying in technology stocks.

- The current market structure suggests a cautious approach, with a focus on hedging and risk management.
- Global economic trends and central bank actions will continue to influence market directions.

Sources

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